reveals that the Brahmi characters could well be Mauryan. The shaft and the umbrella have a Mauryan polish on them.

48. Ghurhupur/Ratanpurwa in Bhabua district (Bihar), not far from Ahraura, is the other place where an Ashokan minor rock edict has been found amidst painted rock shelters. This was reported in 2009 and published by K.K. Thaplyal. There has been some controversy about the genuineness of the edict, although archaeologists like Rakesh Tiwari (personal conversation) and Dilip Chakrabarti believe it is not a fake. See Chakrabarti (2011): 19–22.

49. Sircar (1979): 94–5.

50. Line I, ibid.: 102.

51. This is surmised by Dilip Chakrabarti: Chakrabarti (2011): 28.

52. Ibid.: 29.

Notes to Chapter 7: Extending the Arc of Communication to Afghanistan

1. For the geographic zones of Afghanistan, Dupree (1997): 3–31.

2. Dupree (1997): 19–21. For routes of communication, Channing (1885).

3. Lahiri (1992): 64.

4. Shaffer (1978): 172.

5. Ciarla (1981): 57. For ceramics that are commonly found in this time in the Indo-Iranian borderland, Biscione (1984).

6. Chakrabarti (2006): 147.

7. Bernard (2005): 16–17.

8. MacDowall and Taddei (1978): 188–9; also Stoneman (2010): 365.

9. Kosmin (2014): 33.

10. Ibid.

11. Channing (1885): 360.

12. Mukherjee (1984): 35–42.

13. Ibid.: 9–22.

14. Ibid.: 28–32.

15. Vogelsang (1985): 55.

16. Helms (1982): 1.